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FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC, MUBI

(DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION)

A LECTURE GUIDE ON PAD 111

(ELEMENT OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION)

"A" PART

BY:

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Introduction

Public administration is the non-political public bureaucracy operating in apolitical system; deals with the ends of the State, the sovereign will, the public interests and laws; is the business side of government and as such concerned with policy execution, but it is also concerned with policy-making; covers all three branches of government, although it tends to be concentrated in the executive branch; provides regulatory and service functions to the people in order to attain good life; differs significantly from private administration, especially in its emphasis on the public; and is interdisciplinary in nature as it draws upon other social sciences like political science, economics and sociology

WHAT IS ADMINISTRATION?

According to J.M Pfiffner (1946) Administration consists of getting the work of government done by coordinating the efforts of people so that they can work together to accomplish their set tasks.

Herbert A. Simon **says (1957)** "In its broadest sense, administration can be defined as the activities of groups cooperating to accomplish common goals

In the word of **D. Waldo (1967)** "Administration is a type of co-operative human effort that has a high degree of rationality."

Also Luther Gullick **says (1937)** "Administration has to do with getting things done; with the accomplishment of defined objectives."

WHAT IS PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION?

According to Woodrow Wilson(1889)Public administration is the detailed and systematic application of law. Every particular application of law is an act of administration

According to Luther Gullick (1937) Public administration is that part of the science of administration, which has to do with the government; it concerns itself primarily with the executive branch where the work of the government is done, though there are obviously problems also in connection with the legislative and judicial branches.

According to F.A. Nigro and L.G. Nigro. Public Administration: is co-operative group effort in a public setting;covers all three branches-executive, legislative, and judicial, and their inter-relationships; has an important role in the formulation of public policy and is thus a part of the political process; is different in significant ways from private administration; and is closely associated with numerous private groups and individuals in providing services to the community"

The traditional definitions of Public Administration, which are given above reflect the view that the Public Administration is only involved in carrying out the policies and programmes of the government. It reflect that it has no role in policy making and also locates the administration in the executive branch but today the term public administration is used in a broader sense that it is not only involved in carrying out the programmes of the government, but it also plays an important role in policy formulation and covers the three branches of the government.

Public Administration: An Art or a Science

At a first glance it seems easier to accept public administration as an art. It is just the administration of Government affairs and for most part it does not follow the laws of Science like absence of normative value, predictability of behavior and universal application. So, does that mean we cannot list it into a respectable category of scientific subjects?

There are many authors who ferociously defended it and argued that public administration as an area of study is indeed a Science. The earliest of them was Lorenz von Stein an 1855, a German professor from Vienna who said that public administration is an integrated Science and viewing it just as administrative laws was a restrictive definition.

In modern times, categorizing public administration as Science found favor with many, the most important one being the father of American public administration, President Woodrow Wilson. We shall read more about the Wilsonian view of public administration in the next article, however he mainly emphasized that the objective of administrative study is to discover what government can properly and successfully do and how it can do those things with utmost efficiency with least possible cost of money or energy.

After Wilson another important argument came from Frederick Taylor who wrote a book called The Principles of Scientific Management (1911) in which he proposed to discover one best way of doing things/operation and thus save on cost on time and energy.

Luther Gulick and L Urvick collectively published, Papers on the Science of Administration which reaffirmed its status as a Science.

W F Willoughby stated that public administration like Science has certain fundamental principles which can be generally applied and therefore it is a Science

However, there still remain certain aspects to be established before public administration can be actually and in real terms, be classified as a Science. The places of normative values in public administration should be clearly defined.

Scope of Public Administration

Several writers have defined the scope of public administration in varying terms. Gullick sums up the scope of the subject by the letters of the word **POSDCoRB** which denote: Planning, Organisation, Staffing, Directing, Coordinating reporting the Budgeting.

Planning means the working out in broad outline the things to be done, the methods to be adopted to accomplish the purpose.

Organization means the establishment of the formal structure of authority through which the work is sub-divided, arranged, defined and coordinated.

Staffing means the recruitment and training of the personnel and their conditions of work.

Directing means making decisions and issuing orders and instructions.

Coordinating means inter-relating the work of various divisions, sections and other parts of the organization.

Reporting means informing the superiors within the agency to whom the executive is responsible about what is going on.

Budgeting means fiscal planning, control and accounting.

According to Guilick the POSDCoRB activities are common to all organisations. They are the common problems of management which are found in different agencies regardless of the nature of the work they do.POSDCoRB gives unity, certainty, and definiteness and makes the study more systematic.

CRITICISM

The critics pointed out that the **POSDCoRB** activities were neither the whole of administration, nor even the most important part of it. The POSDCoRB view overlooks the fact that deferent agencies are faced with different administrative problems, which are peculiar to the nature of the services, they render and the functions they performed. The POSDCoRB view takes into consideration only the common technique s of the administration and ignores the study of the 'subject matter' with which the agency is concerned. A major defect is that the POSDCoRB view does not contain any reference to the formulation and implementation of the policy. Therefore, the scope of administration is defined very narrowly, being too inward looking and too conscious of the top management.

The term Hierarchy is derived from the Greek words hieros ("sacred") and archein ("rule" or "order"). In modern societies, hierarchical organizations pervade all aspects of life. Yet they were increasingly criticized in the early 21st century because the features that made them an effective means of organization were deemed problematic.

Hierarchy can therefore be define as a ranking of positions of authority, often associated with a chain of command and control.

Chain of Command

A chain of command is a ladder of authority where those in charge of an organization or company direct and control employees below them. A chain of command details how junior employees should report to and when to consult a figure of authority regarding a particular issue in the organization. In a business, the chain of command directs reporting relationships of employees from the bottom to the top, who should report to who and when. This allows accountability, lines of authority, and the power to make decisions. A well-coordinated chain of command guarantees that any available vacancy and each department have individuals bearing primary responsibilities.

Unity of Command

Unity of command provides that an employee is responsible to only one supervisor, who in turn is responsible to only one supervisor, and so on up the organizational hierarchy. This is true even if the top of the organization is led by a group of people. For example, imagine you are the CEO of a technology firm in Silicon Valley. While the board of directors of your company governs the policy making and

Span of control

This refers to the number of staff members that report to a particular manager/administrator. The History of Scientific Management Theory.

The history of scientific management theory begins with 20th century mechanical engineer Frederick Winslow Taylor. In Taylor's time, America was on the cusp of industrialization, but management methods had not yet changed to keep up with changes in technology. While working at a steel manufacturing plant, Taylor observed several production problems. Taylor set out to solve these problems. He designed specialized shovels and other tools. He advocated for workers to be matched to the projects for which they were most naturally gifted. He trained managers in his methods so that they could implement scientific management theory in their own workplaces.

Taylor is credited with revolutionizing productivity in the American workforce. At his own steel plant, the amount of pig iron the workers could transport in a day reportedly tripled once they adopted his methods. His ideas spread rapidly and helped give rise to the Industrial Age. Scientific management is sometimes even referred to as "Taylorism" in his honor.

What is Scientific Management Theory?

Scientific management theory was propounded by an Engineer **Fredirick Winslow Taylor(1911)** that viewed everything scientifically and since he was into the production field, he was concerned with increasing efficiency of workers to increasing production with least possible resources.

The scientific method consists of three steps: observation, experimentation, and analysis. In science, this could mean observing the effects of a treatment, experimenting with a different treatment, and analyzing the results. Similarly, managers use scientific management theory to observe their workplaces, test different methods of completing tasks, and analyze the effect of the changes.

When properly implemented, scientific management theory improves productivity. It is an evidence-based method that prioritizes efficiency and reliability. Having scientifically rigorous work methods in place creates clear expectations for employees because it establishes a single right way to do things. It also gives managers a unified standard against which to evaluate their employees.

Scientific management theory has grown exponentially since its inception. There are now a variety of management strategies that fall under the [illegible] of scientific management theory. Each of these strategies has its own strengths and weaknesses. It's important to do your own research into scientific management theory to find the best applications for it in your workplace.

Human Relations Theory of Public Administration

The Human Relations Theory otherwise known as neo-classical theory (new classical) with the basic assumption that psychological and social aspect of individual and his work group ought to be emphasized(**Hicks and Gullet 1975**).

There was an experiment conducted on the workers of the Hawthorne Works of the Western Electricals in the spring of 1927 in Chicago. The experiment was being conducted by Elton Mayo and Fritz Roethlisberger, the former being an Australian organizational theorist and the latter was his employee.

The experiment was later known as the Hawthorne experiment and the findings were called the Hawthorne effect. Elton Mayo is often coveted as the father of the Human Relations Movement and his experiment and studies are the most referenced piece of work not just in public administration but also in people management in organizations.The Hawthorne experiment set out to find the relationship between the work conditions, the general fatigue and resulting monotony in the employees. It was believed that the relationship can be gauged by studying the effect of temperature, humidity lighting and hours of sleep.The findings of the Hawthorne experiment shocked the social scientists in many ways. The experiment was carried out on a piece rate wage system for the participant workers. It was seen that the workers were motivated to work for money only till the time when they would ensure an adequate income and refused to work more than that. This simple but startling revelation created quite a shakeup for the scientists as it clearly challenged the Taylorian principle of scientific management.

Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

A CEO (Chief Executive Officer) is the top-ranking individual employee within an organization. They are an employee in the sense that they work for the firm (as opposed to being elected by shareholders), but he or she is not a run-of-the-mill staff member; they have considerable responsibility and influence within the firm.

Having said that, in organizations with a healthy corporate governance function, the Chief Executive Officer is also not an all-powerful leader with unchecked power and decision making authority. The CEO reports directly to, and is ultimately accountable to, the firm's Board of Directors (the members of which are elected by shareholders).

How to Achieve Organizational Goals and Objectives

1. Set SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound) Goals

SMART goals are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound. Setting SMART goals helps the companies to ensure that goals are well-defined, realistic, and achievable.

Specific: Be specific as possible whenever you are defining your goals. A specific goal answers questions like:

Measurable: Quantifying the company's goals makes it easier for you to track progress and know when you've reached the finish line.

Achievable: Goals should be realistic. It should stretch your abilities but still remain possible.

Realistic: A SMART goal should be realistic. It can be realistically achieved, given the available resources and time. It is likely realistic if you believe it can be Ssuccessfully achieved.

Time-Bound: A SMART goal must be time-bound because it has a start and finish date. If the goal is not constrained by time, there will be no urgency and, therefore, the motivation will be less to achieve the goal.

2. Craft a Clear Plan of Action.

Once you have set SMART goals, you need to develop a clear plan of action to achieve them. This plan should identify the steps that need to be taken, the resources that will be needed, and the timeline for completion. It is important involve key stakeholders in the planning process to ensure everyone is aligned on the goals and how they will be achieved.

3. Mitigate Distractions

In today's fast-paced world, staying focused and avoiding distractions can be difficult. However, it is essential to eliminate distractions as much as possible when working towards important goals.

4. Employ Efficient Time Management

Time management is essential for achieving organizational goals

5. Delegate or Eliminate Less Important Tasks: If possible, delegate or eliminate less important tasks. This will free up your time and energy to focus on the most important tasks.

6. Automate Tasks: Automate repetitive tasks. This will free up your time to focus on more important tasks.

7. Always Track Progress

It is important to track your progress toward your goals so that you can stay on track and make adjustments as needed.

Celebrate your Successes: When you reach a milestone or achieve a goal, celebrate your success! This will help you to stay motivated and on track.

Role of chief Executive officer (CEO) in an ganization:

The CEO is the person that is responsible for directing the organization/company and creating the overall strategy that is going to be implemented by all of the organization's employees.

A CEO may not be directly involved in the organization's day-to-day interaction, but they are responsible for the organization's image in the public's eye. They are directly involved with the board of directors and external parties to find opportunities for collaboration.

In general, the CEO is the organization's conceiver. They are the ones who create the organization's strategic plan, build a positive organization culture, and connect with other parties.

Managing budget

As mentioned above, the CEO is barely involved in the company's daily operations. However, the CEO is responsible for the organization/company's entire budget.

The Chief Financial Officer (CFO) will typically handle the budget management details. But the CEO will determine the yearly budget with some consideration, such as the organization/ company's income, cash flow, and target valuation.

With the CFO's help, the CEO will consider several industry variables to determine the expenses potential, revenue, and long-term profit. Then the CFO will handle the rest.

The board of directors is the CEO's best friend or worst enemy. To keep them on the good side, the CEO has to communicate every business decision they've made, the good ones or the bad ones.

They have to do routine meetings to keep the communication line open. This is the chance for the CEO to deliver any news regarding the organization/company's interests as transparent as possible.

Overseeing the organization's performance

This is the main role of a CEO. The CEO can make the right decision by looking at the revenue growth data, etc. These decisions are the basis for the organization's new Key Performance Indicators (KPI) that are more suitable for the organization/ company's next target.

On top of the company's performance, the CEO also has to oversee the changes in the market, such as acquisition potential or the industry's regulation change. This is done to adjust the company's business plan in the future. It will also help the company face external challenges and achieve its long-term goals.

Building the organization's culture

The organization's culture portrays the organization's values and will determine how the employee should behave in the company's name.

CEOs need to understand the culture they are trying to implement in the company to increase the employee's performance. For startups, typically, the culture goes like this: the work hours and the location are flexible, casual dress code, and non-hierarchical relations between the employees.

Well, that sums up the CEO's roles and responsibilities. From the outside, people may think that the CEO lives a fancy life But behind all that glam, there are huge responsibilities with high risk.Because when the CEO takes a wrong turn, they harm not only themselves but also the organization's credibility and reputation.